Ford Motor Company

September 2000

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: Safety Recall 00S31: Certain 2000 Model Year Focus Vehicles – Left Rear Wheel Retention

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 2000 model year Focus vehicles built at the Wayne Assembly Plant from July 19, 1999 through April 28, 2000, and vehicles built at the Hermosillo Assembly Plant from October 4, 1999 through May 6, 2000.

SAFETY CONCERN

Some of the affected vehicles may have insufficient wheel bearing clamp load. This could allow the left rear wheel and drum assembly to separate from the vehicle, potentially resulting in a vehicle crash. Prior to separation, the driver may notice loud grinding or clunking noise from the rear of the vehicle or feel rear wheel wobble or vibration.

SERVICE ACTION

The dealer will first inspect for 'play' in either rear wheel bearing and replace damaged components as directed in Attachment III. Then, a wheel retention cap will be installed on the left-hand rear wheel spindle. A retention cap is not required on the right-hand rear spindle because the wheel rotation naturally tightens the wheel bearing nut.

NOTE: One special service tool kit will be mailed to each dealer on or about October 2, 2000.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……...1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,

Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

Safety Recall 00S31
Certain 2000 Focus Vehicles
Left Rear Wheel Retention

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer VIN list which you will receive in the Ford Dealer Consolidated Communicator (FDCC). Also, correct other eligible vehicles which are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the list. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

RENTAL CARS

In cases where inspection reveals the need for further rear wheel bearing and spindle repairs, Ford Motor Company will pay for a rental vehicle, except for fuel which will be at owner's expense. Rental vehicles are authorized for a maximum of 3 days. Enter the word "RENTAL" plus the number of days the vehicle was used in the Miscellaneous Expense area. Follow ESP cost guidelines.

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LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Inspect both rear wheel bearings and install left rear wheel retention kit.	00S31B	0.4 Hour
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Parts will not be direct shipped for this recall. Order your parts requirement through normal order processing channels as noted below:

Stock & Interim Orders	Effective immediately	Normal order process
Emergency Orders	Before October 27, 2000	Call 1-800-325-5621
Emergency Orders	After October 27, 2000	Normal order process

Part Number	Description	Quantity
YS4Z-1A154-AA	Rear Wheel Retention Kit	1

DOR/COR

DOR/COR Number 50186 identifies parts ordered for this campaign through the Recall Hotline (1-800-325-5621).

SPECIAL SERVICE TOOL KIT

Each dealership will receive one set of special service tools (Drill Guide #204-304/1 and Drill Bit #204-304/2) on about October 2, 2000. Each drill bit is designed to service approximately (25) vehicles.

Additional tools may be obtained by calling 1-800-ROTUNDA (1-800-768-8632) and then selecting "option 4". Please be prepared to provide the operator with the tool number(s), dealer P&A code, and shipping information.

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DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to DOES II or your updated Price Book.

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121
1-800-392-3673

October 2000

00S31

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that a defect which relates to motor vehicle safety exists in certain 2000 Focus vehicles.

What the safety issue is….	Some of the affected vehicles may have insufficient wheel bearing clamp load. This could allow the left rear wheel and drum assembly to separate from the vehicle, potentially resulting in a vehicle crash. Prior to separation, you may notice loud grinding or clunking noise from the rear of the vehicle or feel rear wheel wobble or vibration.
What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do...	Ford Motor Company will repair your vehicle free of charge (parts and labor). Owners who are affected by this recall are requested to return their vehicle to their dealer for inspection of the rear wheel bearings and installation of a redundant rear wheel retention cap to prevent left rear wheel separation.
How long will it take?	The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.
What we are asking you to do…	Call your dealer without delay. Ask for a service date and whether parts are in stock for Safety Recall 00S31. If your dealer does not have the parts in stock, they can be ordered before scheduling your service date. Parts would be expected to arrive within a week after ordering. When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle…

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

If you have concerns…

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Assistance Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 392-3673
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

Office Hours: (Eastern Standard Time)

Monday-Friday: 8am - 11pm
Saturday: 9am - 6pm

or you may contact us through the Internet at:
www.ownerconnection.com
Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline 1-800-424-9393 (Washington, D. C. area residents may call 1-202-366-0123).

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

QualityCare™ at your service

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs